

HSE TOOLBOX TALK

WORKING OVER WATER

PURPOSE AND SCOPE

Manage fall-to-water, drowning, hypothermia, current and delayed-rescue hazards at jetties, docks and waterside work through edge protection, flotation and rescue readiness.

KEY HAZARDS

1  FALL INTO WATER	2  DROWNING	3  CURRENT	4  HYPOTHERMIA
5  LOST SIGHT	6  SLIPPERY SURFACE	7  VESSEL TRAFFIC	8  DELAYED RESCUE

CRITICAL VALUES TO VERIFY IN THE FIELD

≤ 61 m Maximum spacing between ring buoys	≥ 27 m Ring-buoy retrieval line	100% Approved PFD for exposed workers
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REMEMBER - SERNEM

S

Stop and think

E

Evaluate the risk

R

Remove or reduce

N

Never assume

E

Ensure protection

M

Monitor and communicate

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STANDARDS AND FIELD REQUIREMENTS

OSHA 1926.106 addresses approved PFDs, readily available ring buoys and an immediately available rescue skiff. Fall protection and local marine rules also apply.

OSHA 1926.106(a)

LIFE JACKET / PFD

Provide an approved, wearer-suitable personal flotation device where drowning hazards exist.

OSHA 1926.106(b)

RING BUOYS

Provide ring buoys with at least 27 m of line and space them no more than 61 m apart.

OSHA 1926.106(c)

RESCUE SKIFF

Keep a lifesaving skiff immediately available while employees work over or adjacent to water.

OSHA 1926.501

EDGE PROTECTION

Protect open edges with guardrails or suitable personal fall arrest; a PFD does not replace fall protection.

MINIMUM EVIDENCE BEFORE START

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Over-water work risk assessment | ☐ PFD inspection record |
| ☐ Platform / guardrail inspection | ☐ Ring-buoy and line inspection |
| ☐ Rescue-skiff readiness | ☐ Rescue briefing / communication test |

SUPERVISOR DISCUSSION POINTS

- Where are the nearest ring buoy and rescue boat?
- Who will continuously watch a person in the water?
- What fall protection is provided in addition to the PFD?

PFD, EDGE PROTECTION AND RESCUE READINESS



Guardrail - PFD - Fall protection - Ring buoy - Watch - Rescue boat

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CRITICAL CONTROL MEASURES (HIERARCHY OF CONTROLS)

1. REDUCE WATERSIDE WORK

Perform work from shore or remotely and keep non-essential personnel away.

2. GUARDRAILS AND SAFE PLATFORM

Provide a sound platform, guardrails, lighting, non-slip surface and safe access.

3. PFD AND FALL PROTECTION

Wear a suitable PFD and add independent fall protection where a fall hazard exists.

4. STANDBY WATCH AND RESCUE

Verify ring buoy, retrieval line, rescue boat, trained watch and communication before work.

CRITICAL WARNING



Keep a person in the water continuously in sight; raise the alarm, deploy a ring buoy and activate trained rescue. Untrained personnel must not enter the water.

SITE CHECKLIST (BEFORE STARTING WORK)

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Weather / current suitable | ☐ Platform and rails sound |
| ☐ Surface slip-resistant | ☐ PFD suitable and worn |
| ☐ Fall protection ready | ☐ Ring buoy / line ready |
| ☐ Rescue boat ready | ☐ Standby watch assigned |
| ☐ Communication tested | |

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ATTENDANCE AND APPROVAL

Project / Site:

Date:

Presented by:

Work area:

No	Full Name	Company / Role	Signature
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			
9			
10			
11			
12			